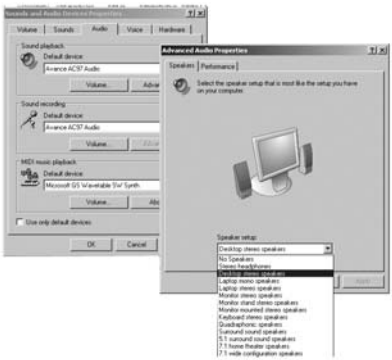
find out which sound chipset is on your motherboard, open up your PC and look at the chip next to the sound jacks; note the name of the manufacturer and model number of the chip. Visiting the manufacturer's Web site will tell you whether the chip supports connecting a 5.1 speaker system. Most new motherboards come with chipsets that support this feature.

If you've connected your multi-channel speakers, checked all the connections, and one or more of them still stay silent, check the power connections—make sure that they are secure and that each speaker is getting power.

If some of your speakers still stay silent, it is possible that your system thinks that you are using a stereo speaker setup. To change this, go to Control Panel > Sounds and Multimedia Audio > Sound Playback > Advanced, and select your speaker configuration from the dialog that appears.



Choose your speaker configuration

Sound Card Woes

If you've installed a new PCI sound card, make sure that you've configured your PC to send sound to your new card rather than the old, on-board card. To do this, right-click on the Speaker icon in the taskbar and select *Adjust Audio Properties*. Under the *Audio* tab, make sure that your default device for sound playback is your new sound card. Make sure you check the *Use only Default Devices* box.

Selecting your default playback device